

Coffee with Dustin Schaffer — Call Prep

June 15, 2026 | 1:30–2:30 PM | Ascension Coffee, Addison TX

Background / History

Dustin Schaffer is Co-founder and Managing Member of Arborstone Capital, which he built from the ground up starting around 2015–2016. He currently owns and operates three portfolio companies — he's not a passive allocator, he runs businesses.

Career arc:

Role	Company	Notes
Tax Senior	KPMG Amsterdam	International, early career
Manager, Tax	Neiman Marcus	Enterprise-scale corporate tax
Partner & Manager, Tax	Montgomery Capital Advisers	Advisory/wealth management
Tax Director	Baker Tilly	National CPA firm
Co-founder & Managing Member	Arborstone Capital	2015/2016–present

Made the leap from high-end advisory work to building and operating real businesses. Understands capital structures, tax efficiency, and M&A — and chose to put skin in the game.

Education: Masters in Accounting, University of Oklahoma – Price College of Business (~2000). **Location:** Richardson, TX. Local DFW relationship.

Company Overview

Arborstone Capital — private holding company, Addison TX. Founded ~2015. ~6 employees. Operator-focused model: Dustin and his co-founder actively run the businesses they acquire rather than managing from a board seat.

Portfolio:

Company	Sector
DFW Linen & Laundry Services	Commercial/residential laundry (B2B + multifamily)
Arborstone Storage	Self-storage
Apex Valet Trash	Valet trash services for multifamily communities

Read: All three businesses serve the DFW real estate / multifamily ecosystem. Durable, cash-flowing, unsexy. Last recorded investment: December 2021 — likely in an operational phase, not active acquisition mode.

AI/tech angle: No public signals of AI investment or tech focus. His world is operational businesses. He's likely curious about AI as an *operator*, not as an investor in the space.

Improving's Position

No prior engagement on record — first or early relationship meeting. Calendar categorized "Relationship." That's the right frame.

Relevant positioning for Dustin's world:

- **AI for operations:** He runs labor-intensive service businesses. AI-enabled scheduling, routing, customer communication, and workforce management is where Improving speaks credibly — practical operational uplift, not enterprise software.
- **Executive AI Workshops:** You've run these for DFW business owners and leaders. Dustin as an operator/owner is exactly that audience.
- **DFW peer network:** Forbes Dallas Business Council, YPO, longtime DFW figure. This is peer-to-peer, not vendor-to-buyer. Lead from that posture.
- **Thought leadership:** Podcast and speaking work as proof points if AI interest surfaces — without making it a pitch.

Avoid: The \$300M company / enterprise platform story won't land with a 6-person holding company. Lead operator-to-operator.

Proposed Agenda

60 minutes. Relationship-first — discovery, not a pitch.

- **0:00–0:10** — Warm-up: how you know each other, what's going on in each world
 - **0:10–0:25** — Dustin's world: Arborstone, the portfolio companies, what he's building
 - **0:25–0:40** — AI as an operator: how Dustin is thinking about it, what David is seeing across DFW
 - **0:40–0:55** — Natural conversation: YPO, DFW ecosystem, shared connections
 - **0:55–1:00** — Close: what's worth staying in touch about, any intro or resource to offer
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Talking Points

1. Operator to operator on AI. "The question I keep getting from business owners is where to start — not 'should I do AI' but 'where does it actually move the needle in my kind of business.' For service businesses especially, the wins are in operations: scheduling, routing, customer communication. Happy to share what I'm seeing."

2. The DFW AI scene is heating up — and most operators are behind. "There's a lot of noise right now. The companies that will win are the ones who figure out how to use AI as a force multiplier on their existing workforce, not the ones chasing the latest tool. The gap between early movers and everyone else is opening up fast."

3. The multi-portfolio angle. "Running three operating companies at once — that's a different challenge than most investors deal with. I'm curious how you're thinking about consistency and leverage across them. That's exactly where I've seen AI create the biggest lift for owner-operators."

4. YPO / network hook. "A lot of the most interesting conversations I'm having right now are with DFW founders and operators who are serious about using AI strategically — not just playing with it. I've been connecting some of them. Worth staying in touch on that."

5. The podcast. "I've been doing a lot of thinking out loud about this through The Improving Edge — mostly for tech and business leaders. Some of it might actually be more relevant to operators like you than to the

enterprise crowd." (*offer to share, don't push*)